

News Weekly

Raphinha hat-trick helped Barcelona trash Racing Santander 7-2

Barcelona thrashed Racing Santander 7-2 to make it seven wins at the start of a season for the first time in their history.

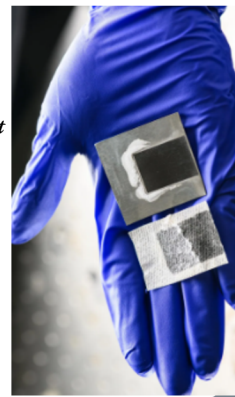
It was yet another scintillating Camp Nou show from Barcelona, who re-established their three-point lead over Real Madrid at the top of LaLiga. Raphinha scored a hat trick, two coming from the penalty spot, as Barcelona led 4-1 at halftime. João Cancelo began yet another Barcelona goal glut with a spectacular 25-yard strike, and another long-range effort from the Portuguese deflected off Asier Villalibre and was credited as an own goal. Gabriel Jesus and Lamine Yamal -- who had failed to convert a first-half penalty -- completed the rout.

Maguette Gueye and Yassir Zabiri provided Santander with some cheer, but Barcelona were rampant and have now scored 33 goals this season at a rate of nearly five per game. (ESPN)



Scientists turn seawater into fresh water without harmful brine

Researchers at the University of Rochester have developed a solar thermal desalination system that could revolutionize how we produce fresh water. This innovative system uses femtosecond laser-treated black metal panels, which absorb sunlight and evaporate seawater without generating harmful brine. The panels feature microscopic grooves that exploit the coffee ring effect to direct salts away from the active evaporation area, preventing mineral buildup. This process not only efficiently produces desalinated water but also extracts nearly 100% of dissolved salts in solid form. These salts can be repurposed, and the system even allows for the extraction of valuable minerals like lithium, offering a sustainable approach to addressing water scarcity while minimizing environmental impact. (Science Daily)



Crocodiles are famous for finding their way home. These ones didn't

A recent study conducted in the Sundarbans mangrove forest in Bangladesh has shed light on the homing behavior of saltwater crocodiles, particularly those bred or raised in captivity. The research, led by behavioral ecologist Associate Professor Ru Somaaweera from Murdoch University, involved fitting five mature crocodiles with satellite tracking devices. Results revealed that three captive-reared females, having spent 8-22 years in captivity, showed no inclination to return to their breeding centers after being released, instead adapting seamlessly to their new environment. In contrast, a translocated wild crocodile named Jongra displayed strong homing instincts, traveling significant distances in an apparent attempt to return to his original capture site. This finding suggests that using captive-reared crocodiles might be a viable strategy in conservation efforts, potentially addressing the low survival rates and long maturation periods of hatchlings traditionally used in reintroduction programs. (Science Daily)



Rare live beetles seized in Philadelphia in alleged smuggling attempt

U.S. Customs and Border Protection officers in Philadelphia intercepted a package labeled as a "play toy" on August 18, discovering three live Chief Goliath beetles, beetle parts, and display boxes. Entomologists identified the live insects as rare female Chief Goliath beetles from Africa and the deceased beetles as stag beetles. These exotic insects are coveted by collectors and often sold on the black market. The case was forwarded to the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS), which requested the shipment be seized due to wildlife smuggling concerns. Live beetles are considered wildlife and require permits for import or export. Elliot Ortiz, CBP's acting area port director, emphasized the commitment to preventing illegal wildlife trade. The USFWS is investigating potential violations of the Endangered Species Act and the Lacey Act for undeclared commercial wildlife export and unlicensed trading (NBC).



NASA spacecraft discovers a huge new crater on the moon

Scientists have recently uncovered a massive crater on the moon, surpassing the size of the Roman Colosseum and resulting from an intense impact that occurred two years ago, initially unnoticed. Measuring approximately 728 feet across and up to 141 feet deep, this crater is now recognized as the largest known impact crater in the solar system formed in recent times. Such significant events are estimated to happen only once every 132 years, providing a rare opportunity for researchers as NASA progresses with plans to establish a lunar base. The discovery, hailed as a "once-in-a-lifetime observation," was detailed in two studies published in the journal Science Advances. NASA's Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter (LRO) identified the crater on the moon's near side in May 2024, after it was created by a fragment of an asteroid or comet. Initially unnoticed amidst the vast data, the crater—named in honor of the late Thomas McGetchin—was confirmed through detailed images gathered by the LRO. This recent impact, which displaced lunar material over 66 miles, is three times larger than the previous record-holder and adds to the moon's ancient, heavily pockmarked terrain. (NBC)



Jokes

What is a ninja pig ?

A pork chop.

Half Moon



2		1				3	7	
7				2				
	5		8				1	6
3		2		7		1		
	7							
				3			5	
8	4				9	6	2	3
			3		4			5
				8			4	

Katsu Mac and Cheese

- Ingredients
- 8 oz macaroni
- 2 cups milk
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp flour
- 1½ cups mild cheddar, grated
- ½ tsp Salt
- 2 thin chicken cutlets (or slice breasts horizontally)
- Salt
- ½ cup panko (pulse briefly for softer crumbs)
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp flour
- Neutral oil
- Boil pasta in salted water until al dente.
- While pasta cooks, make béchamel in a medium pan:
- Melt butter
- Whisk in flour, cook 1 minute
- Slowly whisk in milk until thickened
- Stir in cheddar until smooth.
- Drain pasta and fold it into the sauce.
- Add a splash of milk.
- Season chicken lightly with salt.
- Dredge: flour → egg → panko.
- Shallow-fry in a pan over medium-high heat, 3–4 minutes per side.
- Drain briefly on paper towel.
- Slice into strips for adults; smaller bites for kids.
- For plating, pace katsu chicken in strips over mac and cheese

